

Recording) functionality and record programs as scheduled, and watch them later at your leisure. TV tuner cards are available for as little as Rs 1,200, and depending on the brand and quality, can go as high as Rs 9,500 to Rs 11,000.

Video Capture Cards

Video capture cards are not necessary for the typical home user. They are meant for enthusiasts who would like to do more with what they have recorded. Video capture cards come in very handy in situations such as when you have a home-recorded video on a handycam and want to transfer it to a DVD, VCD, or any other portable media. These cards can also be used to convert old VHS tapes to DVD or VCD with a bit of video tweaking and cleaning. You could opt for such a solution in your PC, but remember that good video capture and editing is extremely taxing on system resources. You would probably want to check the capture card system requirements before buying one. Video capture cards will set you back by around Rs 5,000 for a decent-quality card.

PCI Converter Cards

If you have a motherboard that does not have either a FireWire or a USB port, and you need the functionality but are not in a position to upgrade soon, there is the option to install a PCI card that has USB or FireWire ports. PCI converter cards are generally priced around Rs 500 and higher. Brand names are not common in this category, and you may have to settle for a no-name brand.

Installing A PCI Card

A PCI card is simple to install:

1. Locate a free PCI slot on the motherboard. Remove the metal back-panel cover (if present).
2. Take the PCI card that you want to install out of its anti-static bag, and gently but firmly push it into the free PCI slot. Take care and check that the back panel of the card is not forced hard